Wooden Panel

Wood

W: 18.5 cm; H: 92 cm

Hall 4

Inv. no. 9748



Section of a wooden panel featuring a prominent strapwork star pattern with infills of dense arabesques and Kufic epigraphy, all carved in relief in a style indicative of an 11th-12th century (5th-6th century AH) Fatimid date. Closer examination reveals finely incised lines accentuating the vegetal forms, while the inscriptions repeat the words baraka (“blessing”) and ni‘ma (“grace”), highlighting the auspicious character of the decoration. Similar designs were also found on textiles of this period,

reflecting a shared visual vocabulary across different media. The panel would likely have been affixed in a vertical position, with flanking boards completing the design, as in the central area of the portable mihrab of Sayyida Ruqayya (548-55 AH / 1154-60 CE).

Nadim Foundation ©® 2026